

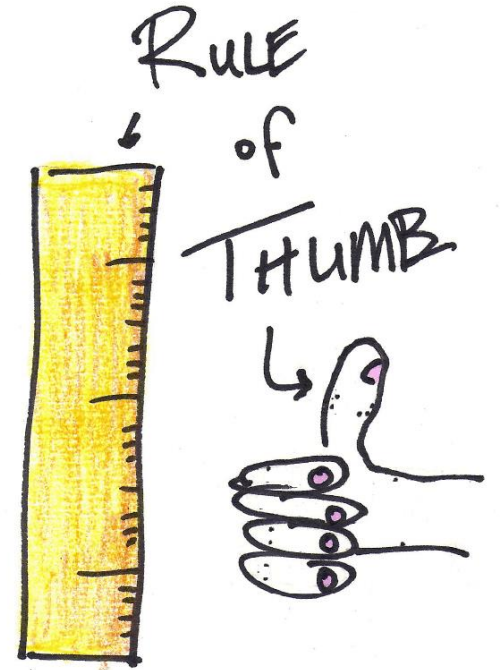
Correspondence

Emails, Letters and Memos

CHAPTER: 6

When writing e-mail, you should try to strike a balance between **speed of delivery** on one hand and **quality of the communication** to your reader on the other.

Don't send it too quickly!



ABC Format for Email



- **ABSTRACT:** Casual, friendly greeting if justified by relationship
 - Short, clear statement of purpose for writing
 - List of main topics to be covered
- **BODY:** Supporting information for points mentioned in abstract
 - Use of short paragraphs that start with main ideas
 - Use of headings and lists
 - Use of abbreviations and jargon only when understood by all readers
- **CONCLUSION:** Summary of main point
 - Clarity about action that comes next

Appropriate Use & Style for E-mail

The same speed that makes e-mail convenient also makes it risky.

Advantages

- Gets to the intended receiver quickly
- Arrival can be confirmed easily
- Reader can reply quickly
- Cheap to use, once you have hardware/software
- Permits cheap transmission of copies/attachments
- Mailing lists reach many recipients at once

Cautions

- E-mail is not private — it may be archived/forwarded and read by “the world.”
- It can be used in legal proceedings, like conventional documents.
- Casual style doesn't reduce the need for careful construction.
- Its shortcut language shifts fast — use it only when your reader will understand.

Email Writing Rubric

Sections	Contents	Format & Quality
Overall Format	Paragraphing, spacing, graphic elements	1
Subject	Descriptive; Short phrase	1
Introduction	Purpose of writing	2
Body	Organized discussion and details/ reasoning	4
Conclusion	Close the letter in a professional manner Call to action Provide enclosure information	2
Complimentary Close	Yours sincerely,/Best Regards etc. Signature/Provide signature block (optional in email) Name Contact (if not mentioned in the last paragraph)	1
Mechanics	Spellings Vocabulary Sentence structure Punctuation	2
Tone	Polite, formal, business-like, positive, to-the-point	2
Total		15

Nine Guidelines for E-mail Writing

“Don't send it too quickly!” — the overriding rule.

1. Use style appropriate to the reader and subject
2. Indicate the context to which your message applies
3. Choose the most appropriate reply method
4. Format your message carefully (headings, lists, white space)
5. Chunk information for easy scanning
6. Use copy options carefully (To / Cc / Bcc)
7. When writing to groups, give readers a way to abstain
8. When writing to groups, suppress members' addresses
9. Consider composing important messages in a word processor